First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 9am-2pm; Wednesday 10am-Noon; Thursday 9am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Louise Haynes

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

April 14, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Dr. Kevin Dirth, Choir Director
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

THIRD SUNDAY OF EASTER APRIL 14, 2024

WE GATHER AS GOD'S PEOPLE

CENTERING WORDS**:** "As Emmanuel, Cardinal Suhard says, "To be a witness does not consist in engaging in propaganda, nor even in stirring people up, but in being a living mystery. It means to live in such a way that one's life would not make sense if God did not exist." — Madeleine L'Engle

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

PRELUDE

WELCOME AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

Call To Worship

All: Within this community

One: We experience God's unconditional love

All: Within this community

One: We rejoice in the risen Christ

All: Within this community

One: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

All: Within this community

One: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer **(Unison)**

Risen Christ, create in us a clean heart so that we can meditate in your peace; abide in your mercy; be filled with your justice; and be made new by your love. In your name, we pray. Amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*PLEASE STAND IF YOU ARE ABLE

[1]UCC, WORSHIP WAYS

MUSIC, COPYRIGHT PERMISSIONS: CCLI #4799426 AND SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
- ➔ Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- ➔ First Congregational Church of St Albans
- ➔ Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- ➔ Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- ➔ Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton

As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative. Including, Adorn Aprons and Franklin County Quilt Guild.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
- ➢ F/GI Community Action
- ➢ Voices Against Violence
- ➢ Samaritan House
- ➢ Restorative Justice Center
- ➢ Pathways
- ➢ Reach-Up

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Hymn*

"Love Divine, All Loves Excelling" (1,2,4) NCH 43

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**

Loving God, in your infinite wisdom, we are glad that you make all things new. Where there is hate, show your love. Where there is war, bring your peace. Where there is despair, bring your hope. Where there is fear, bring your understanding. Where there is scarcity, bring your abundance. Where there is systemic oppression, bring equal justice for all. By your perfect grace and mercy, make us new. May it be so. Amen.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Time with Children of All Ages

Anthem *Make Us True Servants* David Evans

Scripture Readings

Acts 3:12-19 & Luke 24:36b-48

Morning Reflection

Can I Get a Witness?

Hymn*

"Yours is the Glory" NCH 253

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

Choral Response To Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee.*"
Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"O God of Love, O God of Peace" NCH 571

Benediction

Postlude *Follow that Star* S. Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ Maria Barresi Thank You for jumping right in and ushering on Easter Sunday. A warm welcome is so important!!

★ Greg and Melissa Beeman, Sandy Cristman, Paula Kane, Kent Gramm, Amanda Parrott Thank You for all your hard work making FCC a lively & welcoming & fun place to watch the eclipse!

Martha's Kitchen Food Drive

We are collecting the following items for Martha's Kitchen to be delivered in May:

- Ground Coffee
- Iced Tea Mix
- Sugar
- Powdered Creamer

Music Notes:

" Make Us True Servants" is an old Irish folk tune associated with the ballad "With My Love on the Road" in Patrick W. Joyce's Old Irish Folk Music and Songs (1909). It became a hymn tune when it was arranged by David Evans and set to the Irish hymn "Be Thou My Vision" published in the Church Hymnary in 1927.

Zoom Bible Study

Our next Bible Study will meet on April 17; 7-8PM
Text: John 10:11-18
Join us at any time, call Pastor Jessica.

Open Mic

April 20, 7-9pm
Everyone is welcome!

Wi-Fi:

Sanctuary
sanctuary123

